SYED ZARAK HASSAN

Nottingham, England, United Kingdom (Open to Relocation) | +44 7746 712125 | syedzrk1000@gmail.com

zarak-os.vercel.app | github.com/syed-hassan7 | linkedin.com/in/zarak-hassan7

Professional Summary

Technical Builder specializing in the deployment of AI native solutions that turn high stakes friction into automated pipelines. I bridge the gap between systems logic and business speed, wrapped up a Placement at Thrive Learning where my internal builds (Next.js, Claude API) and workflow redesigns were adopted as the company standard for procurement and SecOps, cutting contract and DPA approval time by 70%. I ship production systems that remove manual bottlenecks in procurement and security operations, backed by an MSc in Cyber Security and four years of technical delivery.

Technical Skills and Core Competencies

Compliance Frameworks: ISO 27001, ISO 9001, SOC 2, GDPR, Cyber Essentials. (Working knowledge: HIPAA, ISO 42001, EU AI Act)
Automation Led GRC: Third Party Risk, Vendor Management, DPA Pipeline Design, Audit Readiness, RFI & RFQ Strategy, Access Control, Iru MCP, n8n Workflows.
Technical Operations: Endpoint Posture, Supply Chain Remediation, Incident Response, Security Awareness Training, Pulseway, Kandji.
Technical Stack: Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase (PostgreSQL & RLS), Claude API, Claude Code, Cursor (Cursor SDK Development), Devin, Codex, HuggingFace, RAG Architecture, Vercel, Tailwind CSS.
Tooling & Platforms: Vanta, Cakewalk, Jira, Splunk, Chronicle, Suricata, Wireshark, VirusTotal, BitDefender.

Professional Experience

GRC Analyst - Thrive Learning, Nottingham, UK
September 2025 - September 2026 (1 Year Internship)

- Engineered and deployed ContraAI, an internal full stack platform (Next.js, Claude API) that automated legal review for the procurement team, and redesigned the company-wide DPA tracking process, cutting contract and DPA approval time by 70% and uncovering a mission critical redline that human review missed.
- Built and scaled the Thrive Content Audit Tool, replacing manual ChatGPT workflows with a structured pipeline now adopted as the company standard for compliance cross referencing across the content team.
- Guided the business through a successful ISO 9001 Stage 1 audit by designing 6 end-to-end process flows for non-technical teams.
- Delivered a high-value prospect RFI by mapping security controls to client requirements, contributing directly to deal closure.
- Acted as the technical bridge for enterprise deals (e.g. a major enterprise account), owning the end to end implementation architecture and security responses to unblock high value procurement cycles.
- Engineered a custom remediation script to secure the developer fleet against the Shai Hulud NPM supply chain threat, deploying via Kandji to eliminate risk without developer downtime.
- Led a zero downtime migration of 250+ endpoints to Kandji, reducing IT support tickets by 40% through automated device posture and security blueprints.

Co Founder and Commercial Lead - Nexique Design Labs, Pakistan
September 2021 - August 2024

- Owned the entire GTM and delivery pipeline for 3 years, securing $8,500+ in revenue across 15+ accounts by leading all cold outreach, phone calling, and organic lead generation from first contact to project sign off.
- Achieved a 98% satisfaction rate and maintained a 7% churn rate across 3 years by managing the full account lifecycle, ensuring recurring business that consistently outweighed customer loss.
- Built a custom Notion based CRM and project management system from scratch to track revenue, leads, and delivery timelines, replacing fragmented manual spreadsheets.
- Developed organic marketing strategies and video content that gained 50k+ views, driving significant new business without a paid marketing budget.
- Mentored a team of 5 interns, creating structured tutorials and automated workflows to get them productive quickly without pulling senior time away from delivery.

Projects & Tools

VenderScope - Continuous Vendor Risk Intelligence Platform
github.com/syed-hassan7/venderscope | venderscope.vercel.app

- Built out of frustration managing 50+ vendor audits manually in Vanta at Thrive Learning. Monitors vendor estates 24/7 across HIBP, NVD/NIST, Shodan, and Companies House, replacing annual reviews with a live weighted risk score (0–100).
- Used in real audit workflows alongside Vanta to surface breach history, active CVEs, exposed infrastructure, and compliance evidence across ISO 27001, SOC 2, GDPR, and Cyber Essentials.
- Generates one-click PDF audit reports structured for ISO 27001 Annex A and Cyber Essentials reviews, with a risk score drift timeline showing how a vendor's posture changes over time.

Agentic Pre Sales Automation Suite (n8n)

- **Problem**: Manual tender and RFP response cycles were slow and inconsistent, requiring Pre-Sales teams to spend days cross referencing multi format documents against scattered internal evidence.
- **Built**: An end to end n8n suite comprising interlocking workflows that automate document ingestion, requirement extraction, and AI powered response drafting.
- **How**: Leveraged n8n Data Tables and Claude to parse PDFs and spreadsheets, using semantic filtering to match buyer criteria against a live capability library for grounded answers.
- **Achievement**: Compressed the bid lifecycle into a repeatable pipeline that ensures high confidence drafts and zero downtime reliability through custom Slack error alerts and cost controlled AI routing, unblocking procurement and closing deals 57% faster.

Education

Master of Science in Cyber Security

Nottingham Trent University, UK | January 2025 - December 2026 (Expected)

- **Dissertation**: Investigated whether diagrammatic techniques improve auditor comprehension of complex systems, combining case studies and interviews to demonstrate measurable improvements in understanding at small scale.
- **Relevant modules**: Network Security, Digital Forensics, Secure Software Development and Ethical Hacking.

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering

Iqra National University, Pakistan | February 2020 - February 2024

- Graduated with **Distinction**.

Certifications

Google Professional Cyber Security Certificate (2024) / Coursera and Google

Introduction to Python (2023) / Sololearn

Introduction to SQL (2023) / Sololearn

SOC Analyst Learning Path (2024) / LetsDefend and HackTheBox

- Completed a hands-on SOC Analyst Learning Path through LetsDefend, focused on real-world threat detection, incident investigation, and response within a simulated Security Operations Center (SOC) environment.
- Analyzed and resolved real-world cyber attack scenarios, including Phishing, Malware detection, and Web Attacks.